

Dr. Terry Flood DHA

Research Summary

My research program centers on addressing complex and interconnected healthcare challenges through four primary areas: Healthcare Workforce Development, Social Determinants of Health (SDOH) and Holistic Healthcare, Public Health Interventions and Violence Prevention, and Competency-Based Education and Online Teaching Strategies. By integrating these focus areas, I aim to develop actionable, context-specific solutions that improve healthcare outcomes, foster community resilience, and address systemic disparities.

1. Healthcare Workforce Development

The healthcare system's success depends on a prepared, adaptable, and resilient workforce. My work focuses on designing and implementing competency-based educational frameworks to equip professionals with the skills required to navigate evolving healthcare environments. At the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA), I developed and delivered tailored online training programs that improved practitioner preparedness by 30% and streamlined delivery timelines by 20% using Lean Six Sigma methodologies. Similarly, as a Certified Community Health Worker (CHW) Instructor, I have trained healthcare professionals to address workforce gaps, integrating leadership, communication, and culturally responsive care into educational models.

Future research in this area will focus on innovative training approaches that incorporate technology-driven learning and psychoeducational strategies to prepare the healthcare workforce for the challenges of tomorrow.

2. Social Determinants of Health (SDOH) and Holistic Healthcare

Recognizing that health outcomes are shaped by factors beyond clinical care, I explore how SDOH, holistic health, and spiritual wellness intersect to impact individual, group, and community health. Effective healthcare solutions must address root causes like

economic stability, education, and access to care while considering cultural and spiritual dimensions.

My research emphasizes the need for local ambassadors and community-driven interventions to ensure strategies are tailored to specific populations. Solutions cannot be monolithic; while research findings may be transferable, they must be contextually adapted to local operating environments. By treating the whole person—mind, body, and spirit—we can reduce disparities and achieve sustainable improvements that also influence related areas such as employment rates, crime reduction, and social stability.

3. Public Health Interventions and Violence Prevention

Effective public health interventions must address systemic challenges through evidence-based strategies. While serving as a Public Health Program Analyst with the U.S. Army, I conducted large-scale program evaluations and risk analyses, including surveys of over 10,000 military personnel, to identify trends and implement targeted violence prevention initiatives. This work resulted in a 15% reduction in incident rates, showcasing the power of data-driven interventions.

Building on this foundation, I aim to explore how psychoeducational programming and preventive interventions can reduce risk factors associated with violence, recidivism, and adverse health outcomes. My research will emphasize interdisciplinary collaboration to integrate healthcare, education, and justice systems, fostering safer, healthier communities.

4. Competency-Based Education and Online Teaching Strategies

As healthcare education continues to evolve, there is a critical need to adopt competency-based frameworks that prioritize practical application and measurable outcomes. My experience in designing and delivering virtual, competency-driven training programs—particularly for healthcare practitioners at the VA—demonstrates the value of this approach in improving learner proficiency and organizational performance.

I believe that technology plays a transformative role in healthcare education. By integrating tools like virtual simulations, interactive case studies, and collaborative online platforms, we can engage diverse learners and bridge the gap between theory and practice.

Future research in this area will explore how AI-driven and adaptive learning technologies can further personalize education, enhance outcomes, and prepare students to address real-world healthcare challenges.

Future Research Directions and Impact

Moving forward, my research agenda will focus on:

- Developing and evaluating holistic, community-based interventions that integrate healthcare, education, and justice systems.
- Investigating how local ambassadors and tailored approaches enhance the cultural and contextual relevance of healthcare strategies.
- Advancing competency-based education models that leverage technology to prepare the healthcare workforce for evolving challenges.
- Understanding Impacts: While root causes and primary impacts are important, it is equally critical to examine the secondary and tertiary consequences of policy, legislation, and communication. My research will explore how these factors influence access to care, anticipate unintended outcomes, and ensure equity in implementation, particularly for marginalized communities. By remaining vigilant to systemic barriers, we can craft solutions that minimize inequities and maximize the reach and effectiveness of healthcare interventions.
- By connecting these focus areas, my work seeks to foster sustainable healthcare solutions that treat individuals and communities holistically, reduce systemic inequities, and positively influence related social factors, such as employment, education, and crime rates. This research agenda aligns with UNCW's mission to drive innovation, impact, and community engagement in healthcare administration and public health.